

Inherited California Real Estate: Which Professional Does the Family Need?

Families dealing with inherited property usually need more than one kind of professional. This is a quick reference for sorting out who to call first.

Situation	Professional	What they do
A will or trust needs to be created or updated	Estate-planning attorney	Drafts or revises the documents that determine how the property passes.
The estate must go through probate court	Probate attorney	Files the petition, obtains Letters Testamentary, manages court confirmation.
A trust needs formal administration after death	Trust administration attorney	Guides the successor trustee through notice, accounting, and distribution.
Need clarity on basis, capital gains, or filing requirements	CPA	Determines stepped-up basis and files estate or trust tax returns.
Need a valuation for court, taxes, or a buyout	Appraiser	Independent fair market value for probate referee reports and fair buyouts.
No family member available or willing to serve as trustee/executor	Professional fiduciary	Serves as a neutral, professional trustee or executor.
The family disagrees about what to do with the property	Mediator	Neutral third party who helps resolve disagreements before litigation.
One heir wants to buy out the others and needs financing	Lender	Provides trust or estate loans structured for sibling buyouts.
The property needs to be listed, marketed, or sold	Inherited-property Realtor	Handles the sale, with specific trust and probate experience.

Many situations touch two or three of these at once, a probate sale usually needs both a probate attorney and an inherited-property Realtor, for example.

Wolf Allies is California's referral network for inherited, trust, and probate real estate, helping families understand their options and connect with experienced local professionals. William B. Plevy, California Real Estate Broker (DRE #01956776) and member of the California State Bar. wolfallies.com · Free, never affects your commission.

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